

MOTIVATION

Motivation is not an event.

What really moves the team, and what only looks
like it does.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It is where what a person does best meets a result the
person can actually see.

THE CASCADE

The cycle of the crowd warmer.



WHAT YOU SEE

The team cools off, and you throw an event...



THE MECHANISM

...energy climbs for two or three days...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and it all goes back to normal, at the same cost again.

If the energy ends with the food, it was not motivation, it was distraction.

THE FORK

One question separates it all.

THE YARDSTICK

01

Gone when the gift runs out? That was a crutch.

02

Gone when the boss leaves the room? That was climate.

03

Still there on a dull Tuesday? That was motivation.

Challenge belongs in the head, not in the arms.

THE METHOD

The Motivation Ladder, four rungs.

01 **CARROT**

bonus, party and swag, lasts days and always gets pricier

02 **CLIMATE**

good room and a present boss, lasts weeks

03 **MASTERY**

the person is getting better at the craft, lasts months

04 **MISSION**

the person sees where the effort lands, lasts years

Almost every management move stops at rung one. The game starts at three.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

What to do in practice on each floor.

01 • CARROT

Leave the carrot.

stop rewarding attendance, reward the problem solved

02 • CLIMATE

Hold the climate.

remove the obstacle the person has flagged for three months

03 • MASTERY

Hand over mastery.

give the project the person cannot do yet, with a net

04 • MISSION

Show the mission.

tell them who on the other side gained from their work

TWO MODELS

Lifting the team or motivating the team.

THE COMMON MODEL

Lifting

Talks about the effort

Rewards everyone the same

Creates an expectation of prizes

Has to be repeated forever

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Motivating

Talks about the impact

Names the specific feat

Creates pride in competence

Holds up without you

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three things that kill the energy on the spot.

01 A goal imposed just to fill a table.

→ nobody chases a number they did not help build.

02 Extra effort that nobody noticed.

→ the second time they will not bother, and you will never know.

03 Tolerating whoever says they are paid to do, not to think.

→ that line infects the whole team in a matter of weeks.

| A demotivated team rarely complains. It just stops proposing.

THE CHAIN

The plain question test.

01

Ask three people, why do we do this?



02

If the answer is because it was asked for, you have execution.



03

If it is the client who gains from it, you have motivation.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Thirty seconds of conversation say more than any engagement survey.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves to climb one rung.



STEP 01

Give one person a challenge bigger than they are today.

with an agreed safety net, not a surprise test



STEP 02

Bring one client story into the weekly meeting.

the name, the problem, and what changed after the team's work



STEP 03

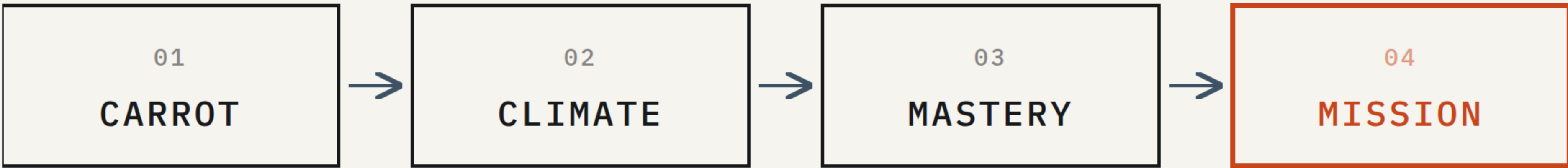
Remove the oldest obstacle on the complaints list.

fixing one old blocker beats any speech

Energy is not injected, it is unblocked.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Motivation Ladder, in the order that matters.



Nobody wakes up motivated by a bonus.
They wake up proud of what they can do.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time you want to lift the team.

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